Jody Youjeong Park

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Research Interests

American Politics: Bureaucratic Politics; Agency Ideology; American Institutions; Policy Diffusion; Race, Ethnicity, & Politics; Social Inequality

Education

Pennsylvania State University 2025–Present
Dual-title Ph.D. in Political Science & Social Data Analytics
MA Committee: Bruce A. Desmarais (chair), Tracee M. Saunders, & Sona N. Golder

KDI School of Public Policy and Management 2022–2024
Master of Development Policy (M.D.P.)
Specialization in Data Science (*Summa Cum Laude*)
Thesis: Does Banning Affirmative Action Hurt Racial Diversity? Evidence from U.S. Universities (*Best Thesis Award Winning*)
Committee: Chungeun Yoon (chair) & Inbok Rhee (Yonsei University)

Ottawa University 2023
Undergraduate Mathematics, Non-Degree Seeking
Cumulative GPA 4.0/4.0 for Linear Algebra I and Calculus I

University of Prince Edward Island 2018–2021
Bachelor of Business Administration (B.B.A.)
Honors in First Standing

Working Papers

Park, J. Y. (2026). Does Presidential Alignment Amplify Favoritism Risk? Agency Ideology, Campaign Contributions, and U.S. Contracting. *Pennsylvania State University.*

Park, J. Y. (2026). Agency Alignment in Congress: Questioning Networks and Interbranch Information Sharing.

Park, J. Y., & Saunders, T. M. (2026). Efficiency for Whom? The Politics of SSA Field Office Closings and Racialized Administrative Burden.

Min, S., & **Park, J. Y.** (invited to revise & resubmit). Exploring the Factors Affecting Workforce Integration of International Graduate Students in South Korea. *International Journal for Education and Vocational Guidance.*

Park, J. Y. (2024). Does Banning Affirmative Action Hurt Racial Diversity? Evidence from U.S. Universities. *KDI School of Public Policy and Management.*

Conference Presentations

Lee, C., **Park, J. Y.**, & Lee, H. H. (2023, Aug 26). *K-Developedia: Telling History Through Visualization.* 2023 Korean Economic History Society Summer International Conference. (Keynote)

Park, J. Y. (2023, Aug 26). *Affirmative action, Racial diversity, and Representation.* 2023 Korean Economic History Society Summer International Conference. (Poster)

Min, S., **Park, J. Y.**, & Yoon, H. (2023, Jun 29). A Regional Typology of International Students in Korea. *Korean Educational Research Annual Conference 2023.* (in Korean) (Paper Presentation)

Park, J. Y. (2023, Jun 20). *The Impact of Ethnic/Racial Diversity of Students on Tuition: Evidence from U.S. Universities and Colleges.* 2023 Korean Association for Public Administration Conference. (Paper Presentation)

Invited Talks

Park, J. Y. (2025, Mar 7). *From Graduate student to Researcher: How to Become a Researcher at National Research Institutes*. 2025 KDI School Job Information Session.

Research Experience

Pennsylvania State University Aug 2025–Present

Research Assistant, PI: Dr. Tracee M. Saunders

Assisted in BRFSS and PLACE data cleaning and analysis using R.

Developed U.S. Social Service Accessibility & Local Racial and Ethnic Diversity Map using ArcGIS and Python.

Korea Development Institute (KDI) Oct 2024–Jul 2025

Researcher, Dept. of Public Finance & Social Policies

Assisted in education panel datasets cleaning and k-means clustering analysis using R, Python, and Stata.

Korea Institute for Vocational Education and Training (KRIVET) Jun 2022–Aug 2024

Researcher, Center for Tertiary & Continuing Education Research

Served as one of the National Project Managers of the OECD PIAAC Cycle 2 Main Study.

Prepared Korean PIAAC datasets; data cleaning using R and Stata.

Translated PIAAC survey questionnaires and interviewer training materials (ENG–KOR).

KDI School: K-Developedia Dec 2022–Aug 2023

Research Assistant, KDI School of Public Policy & Management

Built data visualizations and research articles on Korean ODA history.

Redesigned UI/UX of the K-Developedia website.

Organized data science bootcamp: "Techniques for Building and Analyzing Historical Data using Machine Learning" (Seoul, Feb 12–15, 2023).

KDI School: Collaboration Network Oct 2022–Mar 2023
Research Assistant, KDI School of Public Policy & Management
Built cross-country datasets on the U.S. Visa Waiver Program and non-immigration statistics from 40+ years of DHS yearbooks (Stata). Web-scraped co-authorship network data (Python).

KDI School: Kurdistan Regional Government Policy Consultation Aug 2021–Dec 2021
Intern, Cooperative Research Division
Contributed to English policy consultation reports for the Kurdistan Regional Government in northern Iraq.

Government of Prince Edward Island Jan 2020–Apr 2020
Research Assistant, Public Service Commission
Supported focus group interviews and literature reviews on DEI policies for the PEI Diversity & Inclusion Policy (2020).

Teaching Experience

KDI School of Public Policy and Management May 2023–Jul 2023
Teaching Assistant, Korean Economic Development (Summer 2023)
Developed data visualization class materials using R, Stata, and Notion. Consulted students' data visualization projects, particularly for cleaning quantitative data and designing research articles.

English Tutoring Service Apr 2021–Apr 2022
Private Tutor (Self-Employed)
Taught elementary, middle school students and adults English speaking and writing (Two 60-min sessions per week for each student).

Honors & Awards

KDI School of Public Policy and Management

Outstanding Thesis Award (Class of 2024)	Aug 2024
Student Community Service Award	Aug 2023
Dean's Honors List (Every Semester)	2022–2023
Dean's Honors List (With Distinction)	Mar, Jul 2023

University of Prince Edward Island

Dean's Honors List (Every Semester)	2018–2021
Academic Excellence Award (1,000 CAD)	2018–2021
Ambrose Lee International Student Prize (500 CAD)	Mar 2019, 2021
Diamond Awards (500 CAD)	Apr 2020
Student Adversity Awards (500 CAD)	Apr 2020
Roderick Stirling Macdonald Scholarship Prize (1,000 CAD)	Dec 2019
University Prize, First Year Business (Highest) (1,000 CAD)	Oct 2019

Grants & Fellowships

Penn State Miller-LaVigne Graduate Fellowship Aug-Dec 2026
Selected based upon academic performance and exceptional promise in political science (15,930 USD)

Penn State Summer Research Funding May-Jul 2026
Summer research funding award from the department of political science (5,000 USD)

Penn State Political Science Department 2025–2030
Fully funded graduate assistance scholarship for the doctoral program

KDI School Academic Excellence Scholarship 2022–2024
Fully funded scholarship for the master's program
(28,000,000 KRW; 21,320 USD)

Leadership

KDI School of Public Policy and Management Feb 2022–May 2022
Student Ambassador, PR Division

UPEI–PEI Fencing Club Dec 2019–Dec 2020
Vice President

Soup for the Soul (UPEI Faculty of Arts) Sep 2019–Dec 2020
Volunteer Manager

Professional Experience

Fitzpatrick & Co. Charlottetown May 2020–Aug 2020
Junior Accountant

Skills

Programming: R, Python, Stata, LaTeX, ArcGIS, QGIS
Languages: English (Fluent); Korean (Native)
Certifications: 3rd-Degree Black Belt in Taekwondo (World Taekwondo Headquarters)

Last update: October 28, 2026